

Personal Resume Handout

Learning Outcomes

After working through this guide, you will be able to:

- Explain what an ATS is and why keyword matching determines whether your application reaches a human.
 - Extract and prioritise keywords from a real job description.
 - Apply the Three-Thirds structure to lay out a one-page resume.
 - Write bullet points using the **Action → Technology → Impact** formula.
 - Translate game-development experience into language any recruiter understands.
 - Achieve a relevance score of **60% or higher** on a targeted job posting.
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1. Assignment Overview

Goal: Create a one-page, ATS-optimised resume tailored to a real job posting on JobStreet — and achieve a relevance score of **60% or higher**.

This assignment teaches you three critical job-search skills:



Tailor a Resume

Match your experience to a specific job description — not just your general background. One resume does not fit every role.



Pass ATS Screening

Clear the automated filter that most companies use before a human ever reads your resume. This is the first gate you must pass.



Communicate Technical Work

Translate your projects into language that recruiters and hiring managers understand — not just other game developers.

This is not a hypothetical exercise. The resume you build here is one you can use in your actual job search.

2. Why ATS Matters

In today's job market, especially for **entry-level and technical roles**, your resume is evaluated by software before any human sees it. Many companies use an ATS (Applicant Tracking System) to automatically screen resumes against the job description. Candidates who score below roughly **60% relevance are filtered out** before reaching a recruiter.

This means that even qualified applicants can be rejected simply because their resume does not contain the **right keywords, technologies, or phrasing**.

To learn more about how these systems work, read this article from [The Straits Times](#).

The Two Readers of Your Resume

Your resume has two audiences, and they read it very differently:

Human Recruiters — 5–10 seconds



Spend 5–10 seconds skimming your resume. They focus on the **top third** of the page. If nothing grabs them there, they move on.

ATS Software — keyword scan



Scans your resume for keywords, job titles, skills, and structured data. It does not care about visual design — it only cares about **matching text**.

Your goal is to **satisfy both**: make the top of your resume compelling for humans, and pack the rest with keywords for the ATS.



Key Insight

A resume that looks beautiful but uses a two-column layout might score zero on ATS because the software cannot parse columns reliably. Optimise for the machine first, then for the human.

What ATS Likes

- Clean, simple formatting (no tables, no columns, no text boxes)
- Standard section headings (Education, Skills, Experience, Projects)
- Keywords that **match the job description exactly**
- Plain text that can be parsed — no images of text, no fancy graphics

What Breaks ATS

- Multi-column layouts and tables
- Headers/footers (some ATS ignores content in these areas)
- Unusual fonts or symbols that don't parse correctly
- Graphics, icons, or skill-level bars

MULTIPLE CHOICE ats-pass-threshold

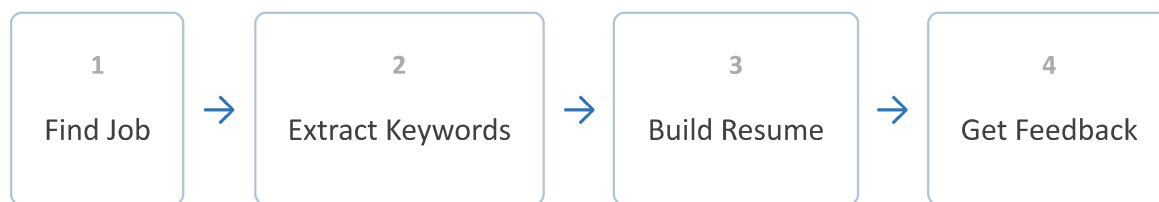
Your resume scores 55% relevance on an ATS scan. What happens next?

- ☐ A recruiter reviews it and gives you a chance anyway
- ☐ It is automatically filtered out before any recruiter sees it
- ☐ You get an interview but your resume is rated as average

Check

3. Resume Building Workflow

Follow these four steps in order:



4. Step 1 — Find a Job

Go to [JobStreet Singapore](#) and search for **one job** that is:

- Related to your degree programme
- Located in Singapore
- A real, currently active listing

Suggested Job Titles by Degree

Degree	Focus Areas	Relevant Job Titles
RTIS — Real-Time Interactive Simulation	Low latency systems, engine development, high-performance computing, systems programming	Game Engine Developer, Systems Engineer, Site Reliability Engineer (SRE), DevOps Engineer, AI/ML Engineer, Data Analyst / Data Scientist, Full Stack Developer, Cybersecurity Engineer, Simulation Engineer, Graphics Programmer, Technical Product Manager, Technical Project Manager
IMGD — Interactive Media & Game Development	Interactive systems, real-time rendering, game systems, immersive visualisation	Game Developer, Systems Engineer, Full Stack Developer, Data Engineer, Infrastructure Engineer, DevOps Engineer, Cybersecurity Engineer, AI/ML Engineer, Technical Designer, Technical Artist, Gameplay Programmer, Tools Engineer, Technical Product Manager, Technical Project Manager
UXGD — User Experience & Game Design	UX design, software engineering, product strategy, digital product management	App Developer, UI/UX Designer, Product Designer, Product Manager, Product Operations Manager, Project Manager, Marketing & Design Specialist, Process Architect, Technical Designer, Technical Artist, UX Researcher, UX Engineer
BFA — Digital Art and Animation	Visual storytelling, CG production, game engine projects	Technical Artist, UI/UX Designer, Creative Designer, Unreal Engine Artist, 3D Graphic Artist, Production Assistant, Project Manager, Project Operations

5. Step 2 — Analyse the Job Description

This is the most important preparation step. Read the job description carefully and extract the following:

- **Required skills** — programming languages, frameworks, tools
- **Responsibilities** — what the role actually does day-to-day
- **Buzzwords** — terms like "cross-platform," [CI/CD](#), [Agile](#), [REST API](#)
- **Soft skills** — "collaboration," "communication," "problem-solving"

Write these keywords down in a list. You will weave them into your resume.

How to Do This Well

For each sentence in the Key Responsibilities and Requirements sections:

1. **Highlight one key term** and its supporting context

2. **Check spelling** — use the exact phrasing from the job description
3. **Target HR-facing language** — translate technical jargon into terms recruiters understand
4. If you use a grammar tool or AI for proofreading, **do a final pass by hand**

Example: If the job description says *"Experience with C++ and Python, familiarity with Git, Agile methodologies"* — then **C++, Python, Git, and Agile** must all appear in your resume.

The Keyword Mapping Exercise

Create a simple two-column comparison on scratch paper:

JD Says: Python, REST APIs, Agile, AWS, Docker, CI/CD, teamwork

My Resume Has: Python (in skills), REST API (in project bullet), Agile (not yet!), Docker (not yet!)

Action: Add "Agile/Scrum" to Concepts in skills. Add "Docker" to Tools if I've used it. Mention "collaborated in an Agile team" in a project bullet.

WARNING: Only include skills you actually have. Lying on your resume is a fast way to fail a technical interview. But if you've used something even briefly (e.g., Docker in one project), you can list it. However, you must feel confident discussing **anything** mentioned in your resume come interview time, so be prepared.

FILL IN THE BLANK keyword-mapping

Complete the statement: Before writing a single bullet point, the most important preparation step is to extract ... _____ from the job description.

Check

6. Step 3 — Build Your Resume

Resume Basics

- Your resume must fit on **exactly one page**

- A one-page resume is ideal for entry-level to mid-career professionals with under 10 years of experience
- It forces conciseness, allowing recruiters to quickly identify relevant skills and achievements

Choose Your Resume Template

Select the template that matches your degree programme. You only need **one**.

Degree Programme	Focus	Template
RTIS — Real-Time Interactive Simulation	Low latency systems, engine development, high-performance computing	Download RTIS Resume Template
IMGD — Interactive Media & Game Development	Gameplay programming, interactive systems, game tools	Download IMGD Resume Template
UXGD — User Experience & Game Design	UX/UI design, digital product development, product management	Download UXGD Resume Template
BFA — Digital Art and Animation	Visual storytelling, CG production, game engine projects	Download BFA Resume Template

Tip:

These templates are designed to be **ATS-friendly**, helping your resume pass automated screening systems.

7. Resume Writing Guide

The Three-Thirds Resume Structure

Think of your one-page resume as three horizontal zones. Each zone serves a different purpose. Click each tab to see what belongs there and why.

1. Top Third — Human Eyes
2. Middle Third — Depth
3. Bottom Third — ATS Keywords

Top Third — For Human Eyes (the 5–10 Second Scan)

This is prime real estate. A recruiter's eyes land here first. It must contain:

- **Your name** — large, clear, at the very top (14–18pt bold)
- **Contact information** — email, phone, LinkedIn, GitHub/portfolio (one line, 9pt)
- **Professional summary** — 1–2 sentences tailored to the job (optional but recommended)
- **Your most impressive project or experience** — the thing you're most proud of

The professional summary should mirror the job description's language. If they want "cross-platform C++ development," your summary should say: *"CS student with experience in cross-platform C++ development."*

Click each zone to see what belongs there and why.

Font Sizes at a Glance

Use **Calibri** or **Arial** throughout. Here are the recommended sizes for each zone:

Zone	Element	Size
Top third	Your name	14–18pt, bold
Top third	Contact line (email, phone, links)	9pt
Top / Middle	Professional summary, body text, bullets	10–11pt
Middle third	Section headings (EDUCATION, PROJECTS...)	11–12pt, bold or ALL CAPS
Bottom third	Education details, Skills, Concepts	8–9pt ← smaller to fit more keywords

TIP:

The only zone where you should shrink the font is the bottom third. Keep everything above it at 10–11pt so it reads cleanly in the 5–10 second recruiter scan.

Recommended Layout (Top to Bottom)

1

Name

Centred, 14–18pt, bold

2 **Contact Line**

Centred, 9pt: email | phone | LinkedIn | GitHub

3 **Professional Summary**

1–2 sentences that mirror the job description's language (optional but recommended)

4 **Featured Project / Experience**

Your single strongest project — 2–3 bullets using Action → Technology → Impact

5 **Projects**

2–3 more entries, 1–2 bullets each

6 **Education**

Degree, school, graduation date, relevant courses (8–9pt)

7 **Technical Skills**

Dense keyword lists: Languages, Frameworks, Tools, Concepts, Platforms (8–9pt)

TIP:

Use tab stops to right-align dates on the same line as a project or job title. This looks clean and saves vertical space.

8. Writing Strong Bullet Points

Every bullet point on your resume should tell a mini-story. Follow this formula:

Action → Technology → Impact

Level 1: OK (What most students write)

Built the UI for a 3D game editor using ImGui.

This is vague. What kind of editor? What platforms? What was the result?

Level 2: Better (Add context and real tech names)

Built the entire UI for a 3D game editor (a digital workshop where creators build virtual worlds) using Dear ImGui and Vulkan, supporting both Windows and Android.

Now we know the scope, the technologies, and the platforms.

Level 3: Best (Tell a story with impact)

Designed a Vulkan-based rendering tool using C++ and Dear ImGui that reduced iteration time for level designers by 40%, supporting cross-platform deployment on Windows and Android.

This shows **what you did**, **how you did it**, and **why it mattered**. This is what gets you interviews.

Spot the Weak Bullet

Which bullet below is Level 1 (weak)? Click to identify it.

- A Implemented an ECS architecture in C++ that managed 500+ entities simultaneously at 60 fps.
- B Worked on a 2D game as part of a group project.
- C Led a team of 5 to ship a 2D action-platformer in C++ using SAT collision detection and a custom sprite animation system.
- D Designed a job market analytics dashboard using React and D3.js that visualised 10K+ job listings with interactive filtering.

More Examples for Common Student Projects

Game Engine / Graphics Project

Weak: *Made a game engine with rendering and physics.*

Strong: *Developed a custom 2D game engine in C++ with a component-based architecture, broadphase collision detection, and sprite rendering, handling 500+ simultaneous objects at 60 fps.*

Web Application Project

Weak: *Built a website for our school project.*

Strong: *Designed a job market analytics dashboard using React and D3.js that visualised 10K+ job listings with interactive filtering and LLM-extracted skills data.*

Team Game Project

Weak: *Worked on a 2D platformer game.*

Strong: *Collaborated in a team of 5 to ship a 2D action-platformer in C++, implementing the physics system with SAT collision detection, tiled level loading, and a custom sprite animation system.*

WARNING: Avoid gaming jargon that non-game recruiters won't understand. See the **Game Dev to Software Engineering Translation** table below.

9. Game Dev to Software Engineering Translation

Use this table to translate game development experience into language any software recruiter will understand.

Practice: Match the Translation

Drag each game-dev term to its industry-friendly equivalent. Check your answers when done.

Game loop

Collision detection (SAT, AABB)

Level editor

Game jam (48 hours)

Shipped a game

Multiplayer netcode

Real-time application loop / event-driven architecture

Drop here

Computational geometry / spatial algorithms

Drop here

Developer tooling / content authoring tool

Drop here

Rapid prototyping under time constraints

Drop here

Delivered a software product to end users

Drop here

Real-time network programming / client-server architecture

Drop here

Check Matches

Reset

Full Translation Reference

Game Dev Term

Industry-Friendly Translation

Game loop	Real-time application loop / event-driven architecture
Sprite rendering	2D graphics rendering
Level editor	Developer tooling / content authoring tool
Level scripting	Gameplay automation / scripting layer
Mob spawner / enemy AI	Entity management system / behaviour system
HP bar / HUD	Real-time UI rendering / overlay system
Collision detection (SAT, AABB)	Computational geometry / spatial algorithms
Gameplay programmer	Application developer / systems programmer
Shipped a game	Delivered a software product to end users
Game jam (48 hours)	Rapid prototyping under time constraints
Tiled map loading	Data-driven level/content loading from structured files
Component-based engine	Component architecture / ECS (Entity-Component-System)
Asset pipeline	Content/data pipeline / build automation
Frame rate optimisation	Performance profiling and optimisation
Multiplayer netcode	Real-time network programming / client-server architecture

10. ATS Formatting Rules

Your resume needs to look professional **and** be machine-readable. Follow these rules strictly.

Do's

- ✓ **single-column** Use a single-column layout — no side panels, no two-column designs
- ✓ **standard fonts** Use Calibri or Arial (10–11pt for body text)
- ✓ **clear headings** Use standard section headings in ALL CAPS or bold (e.g. EDUCATION, PROJECTS, SKILLS)
- ✓ **bullet points** Use simple bullet points (•) for each achievement
- ✓ **PDF format** Save as .pdf — this preserves formatting across all devices
- ✓ **exactly one page** Keep it to exactly one page — no more, no less

Don'ts

- ✗ **tables / columns** Don't use tables or multi-column layouts — ATS cannot parse them reliably
- ✗ **headers / footers** Don't put important text in headers or footers — some ATS ignores these areas entirely
- ✗ **text boxes** Don't use text boxes or shapes — their content is often skipped by parsers
- ✗ **profile photo** Don't include a photo — not expected in Singapore tech roles and wastes space
- ✗ **skill-level bars** Don't use icons or rating bars (e.g. "C++: ★★★★★☆") — ATS cannot read images
- ✗ **colour for information** Don't use colour for essential information — ATS reads plain text only

MULTIPLE CHOICE ats-formatting

A student submits a visually impressive resume with a two-column layout, skill rating bars (C++: ★★★★★☆), and a profile photo. What happens when it goes through ATS?

- ☐ ATS gives it a high score because visual design signals professionalism
- ☐ ATS fails to parse the columns; the rating bars and photo are invisible to the scanner
- ☐ ATS ignores the formatting but still reads all the text correctly

Check

11. Tailoring Your Resume to the Job Description

This is what separates a good resume from a great one. A tailored resume dramatically increases your ATS pass rate.

SCENARIO

Your resume scores 48% on the ATS check — below the 60% threshold. The report shows missing keywords: **Agile, CI/CD, Python (FastAPI)**. The job is a junior backend role. What is your best next step?

MULTIPLE CHOICE tailoring-scenario

Your resume scores 48% — below the 60% ATS threshold. Missing keywords: Agile, CI/CD, Python (FastAPI). What do you do?

- ☐ Ask AI to rewrite your resume with those keywords included
- ☐ Add 'Agile/Scrum' to Concepts, 'CI/CD' to Skills, and rephrase project bullets to mention FastAPI — only if you've actually used them
- ☐ Submit anyway — 48% is close enough to 60%
- ☐ Add every keyword from the JD to your Skills section even if you've never used them

Check

1. **Print or copy the job description** side-by-side with your resume draft
2. **Highlight every keyword** in the JD: skills, tools, frameworks, soft skills, responsibilities
3. **Check your resume** — does each highlighted keyword appear somewhere? If not, add it
4. **Mirror the language** — if the JD says "RESTful APIs," don't write "web services." Use their exact phrasing
5. **Prioritise order** — if the JD lists Python before C++, consider listing Python first in your skills section too

Writing Your Resume (Putting It All Together)

1. **Open your template** (or a blank document) in Google Docs or Word. Set margins to 0.5" on all sides. Set the body font to **10–11pt Calibri or Arial** (see the Font Sizes table above).
2. **Type your name** centred at the top (14–18pt, bold).
3. **Add your contact line** underneath: email | phone | LinkedIn | GitHub.
4. **Write your Professional Summary** (1–2 sentences). Reference the job title and 2–3 key skills from the JD.
5. **Write your Featured Experience.** Pick your single strongest project. Give it a bold title, a date, and 2–3 bullet points using the Action → Technology → Impact formula.
6. **Add 1–2 more projects** under a PROJECTS heading. 1–2 bullets each.
7. **Add Education:** [Your Degree] in [Your Programme], DigiPen Institute of Technology Singapore. Include your expected graduation date and 3–4 relevant course names.
8. **Add Technical Skills** in dense labelled lists: Languages, Frameworks, Tools, Concepts, Platforms.
9. **Review against the JD.** Complete the keyword mapping exercise from Step 2.
10. **Export as PDF.** Name it: `PersonalResume_JobCompany_YourName.pdf`

12. Getting Feedback on Your Resume

Before submitting, you are encouraged to get **constructive feedback** on your resume.

You can use the following AI tool designed specifically for DigiPen students:

DigiPen Resume Impact Reviewer

Give the AI:

1. Your **resume draft**
2. The **job description** JSON (or JobStreet URL)

3. Ask it to **evaluate how well your resume matches the job**

The tool can help you identify:

- Missing **keywords** from the job description
- Weak or unclear **bullet points**
- Areas where your **technical work is not clearly communicated**
- Opportunities to improve **ATS relevance**



AI is for Feedback Only

You may use AI

for feedback only

. Do **NOT** ask AI to generate your resume or rewrite your resume for you. The resume must be **written by you**.

Example Feedback Prompt

Use a prompt like the one below when asking the AI for feedback:

You are a technical career mentor reviewing a student's resume.

Your role is to ****provide constructive feedback only****, not to rewrite or generate resume content.

The student will provide:

- a one-page resume
- a job description or job posting URL

Evaluate the resume based on:

1. ****ATS compatibility****
2. ****Keyword relevance to the job description****
3. ****Clarity of technical achievements****
4. ****Strength of bullet points using the format: Action → Technology → Impact****
5. ****Professional readability for recruiters****

Provide feedback in the following format:

****1. Overall Assessment****

Give a short summary of the resume's strengths and weaknesses.

****2. ATS & Keyword Match****

List important keywords from the job description that appear or are missing.

****3. Bullet Point Quality****

Identify strong bullets and weak bullets.

Explain **why** they are strong or weak.

****4. Technical Communication****

Evaluate whether the student's technical work is clearly explained for a recruiter.

****5. Specific Improvement Suggestions****

Give actionable suggestions the student can implement themselves.

Important rules:

- Do ****not rewrite the resume****
- Do ****not generate replacement bullet points****
- Only give ****feedback and guidance****

End by asking the student:

****"What changes do you plan to make based on this feedback?"****

After Getting Feedback

1. Review the suggestions
2. Decide what changes you agree with
3. Rewrite the resume yourself

13. Final Checklist

Go through this list before submitting. Check off each item.

- ☐ Resume content fits on **exactly 1 page**
- ☐ File is saved as **.pdf**
- ☐ Every bullet point follows **Action → Technology → Impact**
- ☐ Keywords from the job description **appear in your resume**
- ☐ No tables, columns, text boxes, or images in the resume
- ☐ No gaming jargon that a general recruiter wouldn't understand

- ☐ Section headings are clear and standard (Education, Skills, Projects, Experience)
- ☐ Contact info includes **email, LinkedIn, and GitHub**
- ☐ You wrote every word yourself (**no AI-generated text**)